

rec'd 1/5/02

CFO-RC FILE # 2001-140 RESULTS: _____ OBSERVER: Coen Dexter

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS SIGHT RECORD FORM

Species: Purple Finch Carpodacus Purpureus
(Common Name) (Scientific Name)

Date(s) of observation: 15 Nov - 2 Dec 01 Number of birds seen: 1

Sex: ? Plumage: Female or sub adult male

Exact location: Vancouver (Snobhill)

County: Montrose Near by town: Naturita Elevation: 5400'

Length of observation: several hours over several days Times(s) of observation: all hours of daylight

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Brenda Wright, George Steele, Kathy Graff

Other observers who independently saw the bird(s): _____

Light conditions (quality; direction relative to bird's position): great from all directions.

Optical equipment used: 10x42 Swarovski binocs and many others.

Distance from bird(s): 10 to 100 feet

Was bird photographed? yes Were photos submitted? yes

Who took the photographs? Brenda Wright and Coen Dexter

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: The bird was at our

feeder. Snobhill is located on a mesa just above the San Miguel River.

The houses are located in a very large grove of Siberian Elms.

Describe the bird's behavior (flying; feeding; habits; behaviors used in identifying the

species or in supporting the identification): The finch came to the feeder to eat black

oil sunflower seeds. House finches, juncos, white-crowns, and other species come to our feeder. The purple finch is shy but when feeders are active it joins in to feed.

Describe the bird(s) in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include

overall size and shape, and how you placed the bird(s) in the general group that you did.

Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings,

and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Describe other

details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the

identification. The Carpodacus finches are easy to recognize by bill shape bottom →

and plumage. Also they are easy to attract to feeders where they are easy to study. The Purple Finch is the same size as the House Finch it feeds with. The

head pattern is very bold; eyebrow white and face area white. Back is dark

brown with indistinct streaks. Throat and sides of throat have very heavy fine

streaking. Chest and sides (flanks) are heavily streaked with dark brown on

a background of buff white. The lower belly is white and the under-tail coverts are totally unstreaked.

Describe bird's call: None

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them: Cassin's Finch has streaked under-

tail coverts, is larger, bill larger and more conical, weaker face pattern, finer underpart markings

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? I have studied all

three Carpodacus finches on several occasions and now all three have been

List books, guides, recordings, or other sources consulted and how these influenced your at our feeder.

identification: I consulted many guides as I watched the bird come

and go from the feeder. From the first sighting I thought the finch was a Purple.

This report was made from notes made during X or after _____ observation, or later

from memory _____ Date of written report: 25 Nov 01 Signature: Coen Dexter

The bill ^{size and shape} is about half way between the House and Cassin's finch. The brown tail is deeply notched. The purple Finch is a petite bird compared to the Cassin's. I have searched through many Cassin's but this is my first Colorado Purple Finch.